



A PEDESTRIAN runs through rain in Santa Clarita on Tuesday. Showers may linger in the area Wednesday.

# Storm brings test for burn scars

## ‘Goldilocks’ atmospheric river is first major rain of the water year

By HANNAH FRY, CLARA HARTER AND ALEX WIGGLESWORTH

An early season atmospheric river that brought powerful winds, heavy downpours, flooding and even tornado warnings to Southern California was also a significant test for the region’s burn scars ahead of its traditional rainy season.

The storm — Los Angeles’ first significant rain of the water year that began

Oct. 1 — dumped 2 inches of rain in Bel-Air and Beverly Hills, 1.15 inches in downtown Los Angeles and 3.28 inches in Woodland Hills as of 11 a.m. Tuesday. The last time downtown got more than an inch of rain in a single day in October was 2009, said John Dumas, a meteorologist with the National Weather Service in Oxnard.

The storm, classified as a weak, or Level 1, atmospheric river, brought enough moisture to Southern California’s drought-stricken

landscape to delay fire season for weeks, if not months, said Marty Ralph, director of the Center for Western Weather and Water Extremes at UC San Diego’s Scripps Institution of Oceanography.

And it did so without integrating the hills ravaged by January’s Palisades and Eaton fires into large flows of rock, mud and debris, Ralph said.

“In a way this is like a Goldilocks atmospheric river,” Ralph said. “It’s sort

of just right to be mostly beneficial at this stage of the year.”

Officials were most concerned about the burn scars from the January firestorms in Pacific Palisades, Altadena, Sylmar and the Hollywood Hills, which were all at high risk of debris flows.

Burned soil repels water instead of soaking it in, so it takes less rain to trigger damaging flooding and debris flows, Dumas said.

On Monday, Los Angeles [See Storm, A6]

# Thousands of Kaiser workers start 5-day strike

Union seeks 25% raise over four years for nurses, pharmacists, midwives and others.

By SUHAUNA HUSSAIN

Tens of thousands of Kaiser Permanente healthcare workers in California and Hawaii walked off the job early Tuesday as they urged the nation’s largest not-for-profit medical provider to increase salaries and address staffing shortages.

Up to 31,000 registered nurses, nurse anesthetists, pharmacists, midwives, physician assistants, rehab therapists, speech language pathologists and other specialists are involved in the planned five-day strike.

“We’ve been really clear, our workers are trying to keep up and catch up with the cost of inflation,” said Charmaine Morales, president of United Nurses Assns. of California/Union of Health Care Professionals, known as UNAC/UHCP.

Morales said the union’s request to raise wages a total of 25% over four years was necessary to compensate for the far smaller increases workers received in their 2021 contract negotiations, when they received a 2% raise in the first year. She also said the company neglected to meet with various groups of workers at

planned bargaining sessions last week to discuss solutions to short-staffing.

“We need to be able to hire more permanent staff. We’re looking for long-term solutions to staffing burn-out,” Morales said.

The union has proposed an internal registry of on-call nurses who are union members, so that the company doesn’t have to rely on contract traveling nurses. Morales said the proposal “didn’t go anywhere.”

As striking workers picketed at facilities across Southern California, Kaiser Permanente called the strike “unnecessary and disruptive” and said the demands would “dramatically increase” its current \$6.3-billion annual payroll. The company also insisted that staffing was not central to the union’s demands.

Kaiser spokesperson Candice Lee said in an email that while the union’s “public messaging emphasizes staffing and other concerns, the core issue in this negotiation is wages. That’s the reason for the strike.” Lee said that Kaiser’s staffing ratios meet or exceed all California-mandated nurse-to-patient ratios, and that the company “has been proactive in hiring and retaining staff to ensure we deliver the care our patients expect and deserve.”

The company has called the workers’ request for a [See Strike, A10]

# Ban on nonstick pans is vetoed

Newsom rejects phasing out cookware, other items containing ‘forever chemicals.’

By KATIE KING

SACRAMENTO — Gov. Gavin Newsom on Monday vetoed legislation that would have phased out a range of popular consumer products, including non-stick pots and pans, that contain synthetic chemicals with potential links to cancer.

“I appreciate the efforts to protect the health and safety of consumers, and while this bill is well-intentioned, I am deeply concerned about the impact this bill would have on the availability of affordable options in cooking products,” Newsom wrote in his veto statement. “I believe we must carefully consider the consequences that may result from a dramatic shift of products on our shelves.”

The legislation would have prohibited the selling or distributing of cookware with intentionally added perfluoroalkyl and polyfluoroalkyl substances, known as PFAS, by 2030. It phased out PFAS in products for infants and children, ski wax, dental floss, food packaging and cleaning products starting in 2028. Previously used items would have been exempt.

State Sen. Benjamin Allen (D-Santa Monica), who introduced the legislation, Senate Bill 682, said he will continue to work on the issue.

“We are obviously disappointed,” [See Chemicals, A7]

**Newsom spares data centers**

Governor rejects a bill requiring them to reveal how much water they guzzle. CALIFORNIA, B1

# Taylor Swift climbs to top — again

How ‘Showgirl,’ her new studio album, sold a record 4 million copies in first week

By Mikael Wood POP MUSIC CRITIC



THE POP superstar’s “The Life of a Showgirl,” advertised in Century City above, scored the biggest opening week ever for an album.

Madonna’s “MDNA.” Bruce Springsteen’s “The Rising.” Mariah Carey’s “Memoirs of an Imperfect Angel.”

According to the Recording Industry Assn. of America, none of these albums — each the 12th studio LP by its respective maker — has sold 4 million copies in the United States in the decade or more since it was released.

Yet that’s what Taylor Swift just did in a single week with her 12th album, “The Life of a Showgirl,” which Billboard reported Monday had moved 4 million copies in the seven days between Oct. 3 and 9.

That figure, which combines sales and streaming numbers, represents the biggest opening week ever for an album, breaking the record set by Adele 10 years ago when her “25” moved 3.5 million units in its first week.

Swift marked the achievement on Instagram on Monday with a note to her 281 million followers.

“I’ll never forget how excited I was in 2006 when my first album sold 40,000 copies in its first week,” she wrote. “I was 16 and couldn’t even fathom that that many people would care enough about my music to in- [See ‘Showgirl,’ A10]

# Media balk at Pentagon demands

Lawyers say new rule against publishing unapproved material violates free press.

By MICHAEL WILNER AND ANA CEBALLOS

WASHINGTON — An extraordinary new policy from the Defense Department that equates basic reporting methods to criminal activity has prompted a revolt among Pentagon journalists that could leave the nation’s largest agency and the world’s largest military without a press corps.

The new policy, from Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth, is a dramatic departure from historic standards at the department, which previously required credentialed reporters to sign a simple, single-page document laying out safety protocols.

Replacing that document is a 21-page agreement that warns reporters against “soliciting” information, including unclassified material, without the Pentagon’s official authorization, characterizing individuals who do so as a “security risk.”

The policy would force journalists and media organizations to refrain from publishing any material that is not approved by the military — a clear violation of 1st Amendment protections to free speech, lawyers for media outlets said.

Major news organizations including the New York Times, Washington Post and Wall Street Journal, as well as right-leaning outlets such as Newsmax and the Washington Times, have refused to sign the document, with only one far-right outlet — the cable channel One America News — agreeing to do so.

The Los Angeles Times also will not agree to the policy, said Terry Tang, the paper’s executive editor.

In a rare joint statement, [See Pentagon, A7]

# Brutal Grindr attack links man to killings

Survivor of a violent date helped police uncover a suspected killer’s years-long trail.

By MATTHEW ORMSETH

When his date pulled out handcuffs, the man thought it was for consensual sex.

He submitted to having his wrists cuffed and ankles bound together. Then the other man pulled out a baseball bat.

The Feb. 22 incident, recounted in a detective’s affidavit, began on Grindr, a hookup app for gay men. It ended with the handcuffed man badly injured — but alive.

With his cooperation, detectives from the Los Angeles Police Department said, they identified his alleged assailant as Rockim Prowell, 34, and suspected it wasn’t the first time he’d lured a vic-

tim using Grindr.

Prowell was charged in September with killing two men whose deaths had gone unsolved for years, authorities said.

“We needed to connect the dots,” said Det. Ray Lugo of the Los Angeles County Sheriff’s Department.

Prowell has yet to enter a plea to charges of murder, attempted murder, carjacking, robbery, burglary and assault. His attorney, Deputy Public Defender Carlos Bido, didn’t return a request for comment.

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The trail of evidence that led detectives to Prowell began in 2021, authorities say, when a married father of five left home at 1 a.m. for a date with a man he’d met online.

Inglewood police officers found Miguel Angel King’s white Toyota CHR parked [See Killer, A8]



**DODGERS’ SECOND ACT**

Yoshinobu Yamamoto warms up before Game 2 of the NLCS. For full coverage of the series, visit [latimes.com/dodgers](https://latimes.com/dodgers) or [latimes.com/enewspaper](https://latimes.com/enewspaper).

**Israel-Hamas ceasefire holds**

Militants transfer four more hostages’ remains from Gaza under the threat of curtailed aid to enclave. **WORLD, A3**

**Weather**

Warmer this morning. L.A. Basin: 70/54. **B6**

**Markets** ..... **A11**

**Opinion Voices** ..... **A12**

**Rise, fall of a green L.A. bank**

Aspiration Partners’ climate focus drew celebrities. Then it all blew up. **BUSINESS, A9**

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